

Palm OS

Personal Information Managers

 Personal Information Managers are programs that let you manage time and contact information. Palm handhelds come with minimal functionality in this regard. There are several replacement programs that add features to the basic Palm applications while sharing the same database, so information is not lost when you remove the third-party application. Agendus (www.iambic.com/agendus/palmos/), for example, is one such replacement that lets you manage information on your contacts. It offers a very comprehensive calendaring option for your tasks, lets you read office e-mail, allows for linking to-dos with contact history, and much, much more. DateBk5 (www.pimlicosoftware.com/datebk5.htm) is similar to Agendus.

If you are looking for something more lightweight, consider HappyDays (www.palmgear.com/index.cfm?fuseaction=software.showsoftware&prodid=6289), a freeware application to help you remember birthdays, etc. Diddlebug (www.palmgear.com/index.cfm?fuseaction=software.showsoftware&prodid=16870) is another free reminder program. Worth a mention is BugMe! Notepad (www.palmgear.com/index.cfm?fuseaction=software.showsoftware&prodid=839),

a reminder program with alarms.

Databases

 Memoware (www.memoware.com) has information on databases for your handheld. You will also find a healthy collection of free databases at the HandDBase Web site (www.ddhsoftware.com/handbase_palm.html).

Several programs help you create a database for the Palm. Of these, HandBase is a powerful solution that is fairly easy to learn, with database templates. It offers Microsoft Excel compatibility, support for forms, multi-user synching,

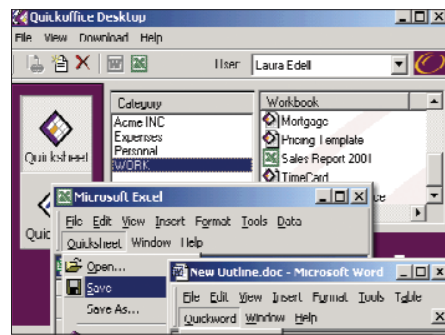


HandBase is a powerful database solution

conduits for ODBC, Microsoft Access and FilemakerPro. Features include linking between databases, database views and field data-types, and timed alarms that can be attached to records. MobileDB4 (www.handmark.com/products/mobiledb) is another application, compatible with Excel, Access and Filemaker, and it brings along a Windows desktop companion. It also supports PrintBoy, using which you can print databases off an IR printer using your handheld.

Office suites

 Two major suites let you type, edit and present documents on the Palm handheld: Documents to Go



Quickoffice allows importing and exporting of MS Office documents

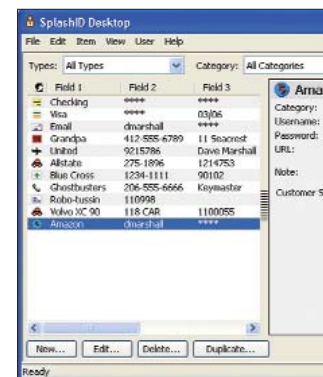
(www.dataviz.com/products/documentstogo/index.html) and Quickoffice (www.cesinc.com/quickoffice/). These offer applications for word processing, spreadsheets, and office presentations. Both talk fairly well with Microsoft's Office suite for Windows: for example, a Word file can be viewed on a Palm handheld with bullets, headings, hyperlinks, tables and embedded pictures intact. Hardware accessories let you use your handheld as a mobile presentation platform. The latest versions now offer native support for Microsoft Word, and Excel files. Quickoffice also lets you create and view a PowerPoint file in the native format.

Wordsmith (www.bluenomad.com/ws/prod/wordsmith_details.html) is a powerful software that can read and write Microsoft Word and RTF documents; high-resolution font support makes editing a document less of a chore. There are several other features as well.

Password Managers

 These are programs that help you securely store passwords, logins and other sensitive information

on your Palm handheld. SplashID (www.splashdata.com/splashid/) and SecureIt (www.schau.com/sit/index.html) are two such programs, both of which use the Blowfish algorithm that employs a 64-bit block cipher and variable key lengths of up to 448 bits. The security offered by these programs is good enough for ordinary use. SplashID supports high-resolution displays (320 x 320), and offers unlimited categories; there is colour and icon support, and it comes with a companion Windows software. SecureIt is a freeware application that also uses the MD5 algorithm for securing data.



A password manager can transform your Palm into a handy e-wallet

Recommended sites

 www.freewarepalm.com: a repository of freeware titles.
 www.handango.com and www.palmgear.com: for the latest and Palm-powered software.

1 Year Subscription at just Rs 600

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